Episode 2: *The Whispering Pagoda (វត្តខ្សឹបខ្សៀវ)*

Full Game Design & Narrative Specification Document

1. Overview & General Info

- **Title: Boon Sop:** The Unbroken Debt — Episode 2: The Whispering Pagoda
- **Time Period:** 1932 (French Protectorate Era in Cambodia)
- **Protagonist:** Sora ([illegible] - Age 24) – Armed with her sketchbook, hurricane lamp, and the bloody map revealed at the end of Episode 1.
- **Location:** Ancient Village Pagoda (Wat) & Scripture Library (Hawtrai), Battambang Province, Cambodia
- **Time of Event:** Midnight during Pchum Ben (Festival of the Dead)
- **Estimated Playtime:** 3 to 4 Hours
- **Genre:** 3D First-Person Atmospheric Survival Horror (Stealth & Puzzle Focused)
- **Engine Target:** Babylon.js / PlayCanvas (WebGPU/WebGL native in-browser)
- **Visual Aesthetic:** Cold moonlight blue, mossy stone greys, flickering lotus oil cups, volumetric fog over lily ponds, and deep pitch-black shadows.

2. Character Profiles

- **Sora ([illegible]):** Exhausted from the terrifying ordeal at the stilt house, Sora arrives at the pagoda at midnight. She relies on her artistic eye to decipher sacred Pali-Khmer scripts and map out paths between ancient stupas.
- **Head Monk Venerable Sophal ([illegible] - Age 82):** An old, blind head monk residing in the quiet monastic quarters. He provides cryptic warnings about Uncle Sok's past dealings and explains the rules of surviving the night of *Pchum Ben*.

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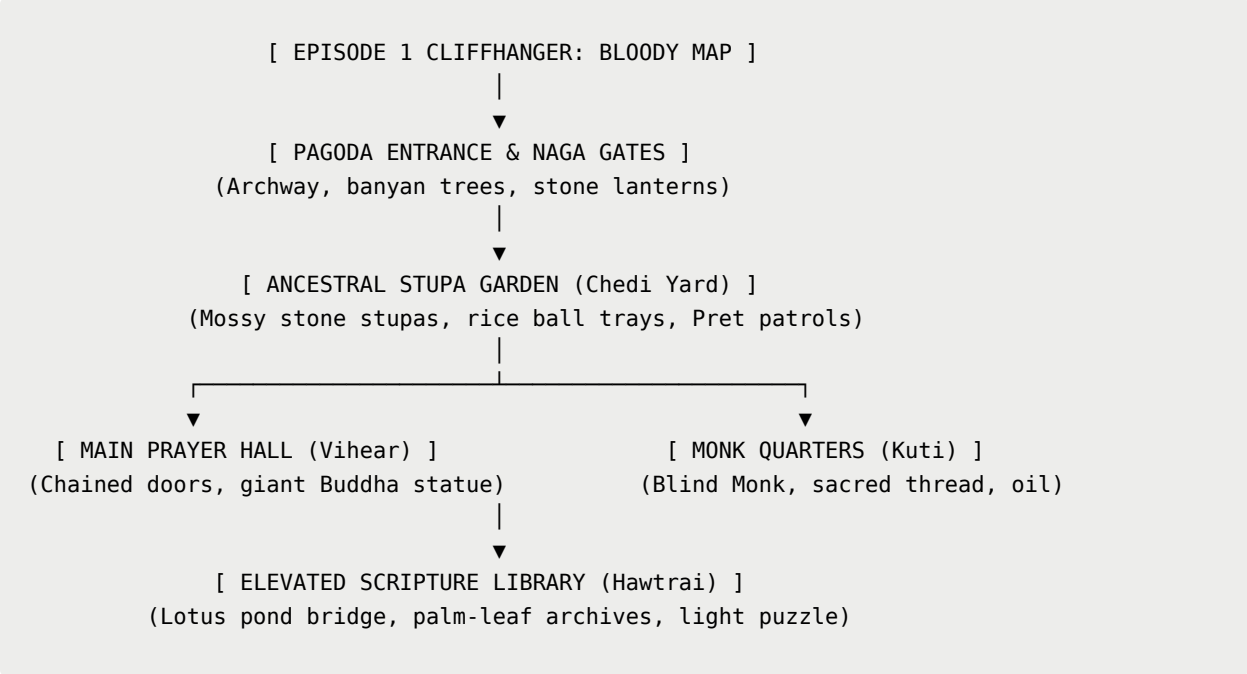
- **The Wandering Pret (□□□□□ - Hungry Ghosts):** Tall, gaunt supernatural figures (3 to 4 meters high) with needle-thin necks, hollow glowing eyes, and distended stomachs. They roam the stupa courtyard searching for rice offerings (*Bay Ben*).
- **The Neak Ta Shadow (□□□□□□):** The central entity manifestation from Episode 1, now stalking the perimeter of the pagoda, attempting to destroy the ancient manuscript before Sora can read it.

3. Environment & Spatial Layout



1. Pagoda Entrance & Naga Gates

- **Structure:** A crumbling 19th-century stone archway flanked by multi-headed Naga serpents wrapped in moss.
- **Props:** Fallen banyan leaves, stone lanterns holding burnt-out oil wicks, and an old iron bell hanging from a wooden beam.

2. Ancestral Stupa Garden (*Chedi Yard*)

- **Architecture:** Over fifty carved stone ash monuments (*Chedi*) ranging from 1 to 4 meters tall, creating a maze-like network of tight dirt pathways.

- **Props:** Burnt incense sticks, lotus flower bowls, woven bamboo trays holding sticky rice balls (*Bay Ben*), and ancient Sanskrit inscriptions carved into lichen-covered stone.
- **Lighting:** Pale blue moonlight slicing through banyan branches, creating sharp contrast against pitch-black shadows between the stupas.

3. Main Prayer Hall (Vihear) & Monk Quarters (Kuti)

- **Structure:** High-roofed brick hall with multi-tiered red tiles and carved wooden pillars. The main doors are padlocked with heavy iron chains, but the windows reveal a towering golden Buddha statue sitting in shadows. Nearby sit the modest wooden huts (*Kuti*) of the monks.

4. Elevated Scripture Library (*Hawtrai*)

- **Architecture:** A 100-year-old carved teakwood building built on high wooden stilts in the middle of a dark lotus pond, accessible only by a narrow plank bridge.
- **Props:** Hundreds of dried palm-leaf manuscripts (*Sleok Rith*) stored in carved lacquer cabinets, brass oil braziers, and polished bronze mirrors mounted on swiveling wooden stands.

4. Act Breakdown & Detailed Narrative

Act I: The Gates of Pchum Ben (0:00 – 1:00)

Narrative

Sora arrives at the village pagoda on a creaking bicycle at 11:45 PM. It is the height of *Pchum Ben*—the night when the gates between the spirit realm and human world open. The pagoda grounds are deathly quiet, shrouded in a low-lying mist.

Seeking guidance, Sora enters the monk quarters (*Kuti*) and speaks with Venerable Sophal, the blind head monk. He reveals that Uncle Sok came to the pagoda a year ago attempting to study forbidden spirit-binding texts. The monk explains that to break the second seal, Sora must retrieve the Ancestral Palm-Leaf Manuscript (Sleok Rith) from the locked scripture library (*Hawtrai*) over the lotus pond. He gives her a blessed white cotton thread (*Sai Sin*) for protection and warns her:

> *"Tonight, the hungry spirits walk among the ash stupas. They have no sight, but they hear every breath. Do not step into their path, and do not waste the rice offerings."*

Gameplay Mechanics & Tutorial

- **Crouching & Shadow Stealth:** Player learns stealth mechanics—crouching behind stone stupas, monitoring noise levels (stepping on dry leaves vs. soft dirt), and holding breath when entities pass nearby.
- **Lamp Shutter System:** Sora can now close her hurricane lamp's metal shutter to conceal light instantly without extinguishing the flame.

Act II: The Wandering Shadows (1:00 – 2:30)

Narrative

Entering the stupa garden (*Chedi Yard*), Sora finds the area patrolled by tall, gaunt *Pret* (hungry ghosts) drawn by the scent of funeral offerings. The gates to the lotus pond bridge are locked with a bronze four-symbol lock.

To unlock the bridge, Sora must solve the Stupa Offering Puzzle. She must locate four specific ancestral stupas belonging to her family lineage (marked with her family emblem drawn in her sketchbook) and place the correct combination of offerings—sticky rice balls (*Bay Ben*), lotus buds, and sanctified water—in front of each stupa while avoiding the patrolling *Pret*.

Gameplay Mechanics & Puzzles

- **Spatial Audio Stealth:** *Pret* entities emit raspy, high-pitched breathing. Players must use 3D spatial audio to track enemy locations around stone corners.
- **Offering Alignment Puzzle:** Reading clues from Uncle Sok's journal and family inscriptions to match 4 offering trays with the correct ancestral names.
- **Distraction Mechanic:** Sora can throw small clay rice bowls to create noise, luring *Pret* away from narrow passageways.

Act III: The Scripture Archive & Seal #2 (2:30 – 3:30)

Narrative

Unlocking the pond gate, Sora crosses the rickety wooden bridge to the elevated *Hawtrai*. Inside, surrounded by shelves of ancient palm-leaf manuscripts, she locates her family's historical record box.

Opening the cabinet triggers an interactive flashback vision: Sora sees her great-grandfather in 1910 kneeling before an ancient stone altar, offering a sacred family relic—a Silver Betel Box (Hup Mak)—to a woodland spirit in exchange for saving his family from starvation.

The vision shatters as the central *Neak Ta* shadow entity slams against the exterior wooden walls of the library, causing the building to creak violently over the lotus pond.

Gameplay Mechanics & Puzzles

- **Moonlight Reflection Puzzle:** Sora must rotate polished bronze mirrors around the library to bounce a beam of moonlight filtering through the roof window, directing the light onto the silver lock of the central cabinet.
- **Retrieving Seal #2:** Unlocking the cabinet yields the Silver Betel Box (Seal #2), engraved with ancient guardian runes.
- **Escape Sequence:** The entity breaks through the roof beams, causing palm-leaf shelves to collapse. Sora must navigate a collapsing, timed obstacle path across the pond bridge while avoiding shadow tendrils reaching from the water.

Episode Resolution & Cliffhanger

Sora reaches the safety of the main pagoda archway as the first bell of 4:00 AM chimes, driving the Pret and shadow entity back into the darkness.

Opening the Silver Betel Box, Sora finds a dried, compressed water-lily leaf inside wrapped around an old photograph from 1925. The photo shows Uncle Sok standing on a floating wooden clinic along the Tonle Sap lake—with a fresh line of blood seeping from the photograph's edges, pointing toward **Episode 3: The Drowned Village**.

5. Audio & Visual Specification Sheet

Feature	Design Specification
Color Palette	Pale moonlight blue, mossy green stone, deep navy, cold silver, and warm lotus-candle gold.
Post-Processing	Volumetric fog over water, dynamic shadow mapping from stone stupas, lens bloom on moonlight beams.
Light Sources	Shutter hurricane lamp, pale moonlight, glowing lotus oil cups, reflective bronze mirrors.
Primary Ambience	Wind chimes ringing softly, frogs in lotus pond, dry leaves rustling, distant temple bell tolls.
Horror Sound Cues	High-pitched raspy Pret shrieks, heavy wooden beam creaks, aquatic splashes, whispering chants.
UI Design	100% Diegetic. Inventory and puzzle clues managed via Sora's sketchbook; light shutter status visible on the physical lamp model.